ance of federal duties. Accordingly, we vacate the judgment of the Fifth Circuit and remand the case for further proceedings consistent with this opinion.

It is so ordered.

JUSTICE ALITO took no part in the decision of this case.

JUSTICE JACKSON, concurring in the judgment.

The Court correctly holds that the underlying lawsuit is "for or relating to" Chevron's acts done "under color of [federal] office." 28 U. S. C. § 1442(a)(1); see *ante*, at 15–16. But I disagree with the majority's conclusion that the federal officer removal statute's "for or relating to" language requires only an indirect relationship between the conduct targeted by the lawsuit and the asserted federal duties. See *ante*, at 11. In my view, the statute demands more.

Understood in the context of its statutory and legislative history, § 1442(a)(1) requires a causal nexus between the targeted conduct and the federal duties, as I explain below. Chevron satisfies the causal-nexus requirement on the facts presented here, so I agree that the Fifth Circuit's ruling must be vacated. I therefore respectfully concur only in the majority's judgment.

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I

A

Since 1948, Congress has authorized federal officers, and people acting under federal officers, to remove lawsuits brought "for any act under color of [federal] office." Act of June 25, 1948, § 1442(a)(1), 62 Stat. 938. We interpreted this statutory language to require "a causal connection between the charged conduct and asserted official authority." *Willingham* v. *Morgan*, 395 U. S. 402, 409 (1969) (internal quotation marks omitted). In other words, we held that the federal directive giving rise to the authority to act must be a but-for cause of the conduct challenged by the lawsuit. See *Maryland* v. *Soper*, 270 U. S. 9, 33 (1926) (explaining that,

under a similar statute, a federal official could remove a prosecution to federal court if the case was "based on or arises out of the acts he did under authority of federal law in the discharge of his duty and only by reason thereof"); accord, *Willingham*, 395 U. S., at 409.

Congress amended the federal officer removal statute in 2011, adding the "or relating to" language. See Removal Clarification Act of 2011, § 2(b), 125 Stat. 545. The question the Court answers today is what this addition means.

B

In responding to this inquiry, the majority considers in isolation the "ordinary meaning" of the phrase "relating to." *Ante*, at 11 (internal quotation marks omitted). Based on our case law interpreting that phrase in other contexts, the majority concludes that this language requires only an indirect relationship between the conduct alleged in the lawsuit and the asserted federal duties. *Ante*, at 10–12. Accordingly, in the majority's view, Congress's addition of "or relating to" jettisoned the causal-nexus test in favor of a looser standard. *Ante*, at 11, and n. 3.

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I think the Court should interpret the "relating to" addition primarily by determining what Congress intended to accomplish with this amendment. *Learning Resources, Inc.* v. *Trump*, 607 U. S. 229, 310–311 (2026) (JACKSON, J., concurring in part and concurring in judgment). Indeed, the Court's "fundamental task" in interpreting federal statutes is to give effect to Congress's intent. R. Katzmann, Judging Statutes 31 (2014) (Katzmann); see *Pennington* v. *Coxe*, 2 Cranch 33, 59 (1804) (opinion for the Court by Marshall, C. J.) ("It is the duty of the court to discover the intention of the legislature, and to respect that intention"). And the Court faithfully discharges this duty when it considers all reliable evidence of Congress's intent—including statutory and legislative history. See *United States* v. *Hansen*, 599 U. S. 762, 775 (2023) ("Statutory history is an important part of [the]

context" in which we interpret text); Katzmann 38 ("Legislative history . . . can help [judges] understand what the law means").

Here, the statutory and legislative history is clear: Congress did not set out to change the causal-nexus requirement with its 2011 amendment. Rather, the "relating to" addition was motivated by a problem entirely separate from the causal-nexus requirement.

At the time of the amendment, 40 States had laws authorizing private parties to compel document production or depositions before they commenced a lawsuit. See Removal Clarification Act of 2010: Hearing on H. R. 5281 before the Subcommittee on Courts and Competition Policy of the House Committee on the Judiciary, 111th Cong., 2d Sess., 1 (2010) (House Hearings).* Federal officers were sometimes the target of such presuit discovery proceedings. H. R. Rep. No. 112–17, pt. 1, pp. 3–4 (2011) (H. R. Rep.). Courts were split, however, on whether federal officers could remove presuit discovery proceedings to federal court under § 1442(a)(1). House Hearings, at 1–2; compare *Price* v. *Johnson*, 600 F. 3d 460, 462 (CA5 2010) (reviewing District Court order determining such a proceeding was not removable), with *In re Subpoena In Collins*, 524 F. 3d 249, 251 (CADC 2008) (determining such a proceeding was removable).

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Congress amended the federal officer removal statute to clarify that presuit discovery proceedings targeting federal officers were removable. H. R. Rep., at 4. Congress made substantive changes to that end; for example, it specifically stated that "any proceeding" in which "a judicial order, including a subpoena for testimony or documents, is sought or issued" was removable. § 2(a)(1), 125 Stat. 545 (codified at 28 U. S. C. § 1442(d)(1)); see H. R. Rep., at 4.

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*The House Hearings were for a predecessor bill proposed the year before the Removal Clarification Act was passed. That predecessor bill included the "or relating to" language that was ultimately enacted. See H. R. 5281, 111th Cong., 2d Sess., § 2(b)(2) (2010).

Congress also made several "conforming amendments." § 2(b), 125 Stat. 545. The addition of the "or relating to" language to § 1442(a)(1) was one of them. 125 Stat. 545 (referring to this change as a "conforming amendment"); accord, House Hearings, at 44 (describing this as a "minor chang[e] to existing § 1442(a) [to] make it consistent" with the substantive changes). The addition of "or relating to" was not a substantive change.

C

That the addition of "or relating to" was a "conforming amendment" is meaningful. Congress rarely changes the substance of a statute through "mere conforming amendment[s]." *INS* v. *Stevic*, 467 U. S. 407, 428 (1984). Such amendments are typically "minor tweak[s]," intended to harmonize or clarify amended statutory provisions. *Cyan, Inc.* v. *Beaver County Employees Retirement Fund*, 583 U. S. 416, 430 (2018); accord, *Stevic*, 467 U. S., at 428. Thus, it would be passing strange to conclude that "Congress made a radical—but entirely implicit—change" to the standard for federal officer removal through a conforming amendment. *Director of Revenue of Mo.* v. *CoBank ACB*, 531 U. S. 316, 324 (2001).

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And indeed, the legislative history here confirms that Congress did no such thing. It makes crystal clear that the Removal Clarification Act was "not changing the underlying removal law," but was instead simply clarifying that § 1442 would apply "anytime a legal demand is made on a Federal officer for any act done under their official capacity." House Hearings, at 2; see *id.*, at 13 (testimony of the House General Counsel that the bill "does not alter the standard for general removal for Federal officer removal under [§]1442"); *id.*, at 17 ("[U]nder the terms of the bill . . . , each of the currently existing requirements of the federal officer removal statute still must be met for removal to be permitted"); 157 Cong. Rec. 2792 (2011) (statement of Rep. Jackson Lee that the bill "does not make any changes to the underlying removal law").

Moreover, the history establishes that Congress *knew* the removal law it was amending required a causal nexus. See H. R. Rep., at 3 ("Federal officers . . . must demonstrate a causal connection between the charged conduct and asserted official authority"). So, with full knowledge of the causal-nexus test, Congress made only a "conforming" change—it did not alter the substantive requirements for removal.

This is not to say that the "or relating to" language served no purpose. By adding it, Congress confirmed that subpoena enforcement and presuit discovery proceedings "fall within the scope of Section 1442." House Hearings, at 20 (testimony of the House General Counsel).

The nature of presuit discovery proceedings necessitated such confirmation. Presuit discovery proceedings seek to get information, not to accuse the target of engaging in unlawful conduct. Thus, to describe a subpoena or a deposition as being "for" unlawful conduct is factually inaccurate. If the statute permitted removal of only those proceedings that are "for" federally directed conduct, then arguably that statutory provision would not authorize removal of presuit discovery proceedings. But presuit discovery proceedings *are* "related to" a defendant's federally directed conduct. See Brief for Former Governor John Bel Edwards as *Amicus Curiae* 12–13. So, "[b]ecause the amended §1442 would now include proceedings that do not seek to impose civil liability or a criminal penalty on the federal officer, [the statute] allows removal not only in proceedings 'for' acts under color of the federal office but also in proceedings 'relating to' such acts." House Hearings, at 68 (statement of Arthur D. Hellman, University of Pittsburgh School of Law).

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In short, by adding "or relating to," Congress confirmed that the substantive changes "broaden[ed] the universe of acts that enable Federal officers to remove to Federal court." H. R. Rep., at 6. The amendment clarified that presuit discovery proceedings were squarely within "the universe of acts" that a federal officer could remove. But Congress did

not intend to change any of the underlying removal requirements—including the causal-nexus test.

II

Although the majority and I interpret the "for or relating to" requirement differently, we agree that the state lawsuit here satisfies this requirement. The lawsuit targets Chevron's crude-oil production activities. And as the majority explains, Chevron's predecessor contracted with the Federal Government during the Second World War to produce aviation gasoline ("avgas"), a product refined from crude oil. *Ante*, at 6–8.

Chevron used much of the crude oil it pumped from its Louisiana oil fields to refine into avgas during the war. This was no accident. The crude oil from Chevron's Louisiana fields was particularly well-suited for refining into avgas, and the Federal Government pushed its refiners, including Chevron, to produce more and more avgas. *Ante*, at 13. This in turn demanded an ever-increasing supply of crude oil. *Ibid.* Chevron therefore produced crude oil, at least in part, to meet the demands of its federal contracts—satisfying the causal-nexus requirement.

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The Fifth Circuit erred in concluding that the removal statute's "for or relating to" requirement was not met under the circumstances presented here. It faulted Chevron for failing to identify a specific contractual directive "pertaining to oil production." *Plaquemines Parish* v. *BP America Production Co.*, 103 F. 4th 324, 341 (2024). But Chevron's federal contracts can be a but-for cause of the challenged crude-oil production without specifically directing that production. Because the Fifth Circuit's contractual-directive demand goes a step further than even the causal-nexus test, I agree with the majority that the Fifth Circuit's judgment must be vacated.

REPORTER'S NOTE

The attached opinion has been revised to reflect the usual publication and citation style of the United States Reports. The revised pagination makes available the official United States Reports citation in advance of publication. The syllabus has been prepared by the Reporter of Decisions for the convenience of the reader and constitutes no part of the opinion of the Court. Other revisions may include adjustments to formatting, captions, citation form, and any errant punctuation. The following additional edits were made:

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None